

Week 23: Prophecy

BIG IDEA

Prophecy is trickier than manuscripts or archaeology: fulfilled prophecy can be dismissed as coincidence or manufactured. Jesus fulfilled Messianic prophecy contrary to expectations of a political-military ruler, establishing a spiritual kingdom instead — a worldview shift. Expect hard questions this week; write them down, research, and come back with real answers.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- Having shown the Bible accurate and historical, prophecy is trickier: fulfillment can be discounted as happenstance, coincidence, or something manufactured to look fulfilled.
- The week's introduction activity and exploration walk students through Isaiah chapters 52 and 53.
- This may be a difficult week: students may start firing all kinds of questions, especially at your small group leaders.
- Don't pretend to have every answer; write questions down, research together, and come back — even taking an additional week if needed.
- Skeptical students may be drawing closer, but the closer they get, the easier a brushed-off question can knock them off the edge.
- Address the misconception directly: Jewish leaders expected a political, military ruler dethroning foreign rule; Jesus unexpectedly established a spiritual kingdom — a worldview shift.

SCRIPTURE

Isaiah 52-53

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Could Jesus fulfilling hundreds of prophecies really be coincidence or something manufactured? Why or why not?
2. What do Isaiah 52 and 53 say the Messiah would be like, and how did Jesus fulfill that?
3. Why did the Messiah Jesus actually was differ so much from the ruler Jewish leaders expected?
4. What questions about prophecy do you still have that we should research together?

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